

Chapter 11 — Succession, Continuity, Emergency Authority, and Institutional Recovery

Document control: HAL Book VII v1.0; Certified Final; 2026-07-27; owner: Governance Steward.

1. Purpose

Preserve lawful governance through absence, incapacity, disaster, compromise, and transition.

2. Scope

This chapter governs Owner succession, all transitions, compromise, continuity plans, critical roles, emergency vacancies, governance recovery, quarantine recovery. It defines institutional procedure and does not create constitutional, technical, operational, or security authority.

3. Authority and source requirements

Book I Decisions 47-48, 51, 58; Book II continuity/recovery architecture; Book VIII recovery assurance. Book I prevails. Final Books V and VI retain their operational and security/privacy/trust execution authorities; Book VII supplies institutional governance only.

4. Definitions and roles

Primary accountable roles: Constitutional Steward, Appointing Authority, Continuity Steward, Recovery Authority, Security Authority, Governance Archivist. Authority means explicit bounded permission to decide; expertise and administrative access do not create it.

5. Normative controls

CNT-11-001 — Separate ownership succession

Owner transfer or succession **MUST** use the constitutional procedure and **MUST NOT** be inferred from custody, kinship, employment, access, incapacity, or emergency role.

- Applicability: Owner succession
- Responsible role: Constitutional Steward
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Constitutional Succession Record
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: Owner/constitutional process

CNT-11-002 — Plan role succession

Every critical governance role **MUST** define deputies, activation criteria, authority limits, term, handback, records, and disqualification conditions.

- Applicability: critical roles
- Responsible role: Appointing Authority
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Role Succession Plan
- Severity: High

- Exception authority: Appointing Authority

CNT-11-003 — Test continuity

Governance continuity plans **MUST** be exercised for identity compromise, unavailable Owner, unavailable authority, lost records, split authority, communication failure, and facility loss.

- Applicability: continuity plans
- Responsible role: Continuity Steward
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Governance Continuity Exercise
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: none

CNT-11-004 — Restore authority before business

Institutional recovery **MUST** verify Owner identity, constitutional state, authority records, audit integrity, and decision-register continuity before ordinary governance resumes.

- Applicability: governance recovery
- Responsible role: Recovery Authority
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Governance Recovery Admission
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: none

CNT-11-005 — Quarantine compromised roles

A suspected compromised identity, credential, device, record system, or governance body **MUST** lose affected decision authority while evidence is preserved and independent recovery proceeds.

- Applicability: compromise
- Responsible role: Security Authority
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Governance Quarantine Record
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: none

CNT-11-006 — Prevent self-release

A quarantined person, role, body, or system **MUST NOT** approve its own restoration to authority.

- Applicability: quarantine recovery
- Responsible role: Recovery Authority
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Independent Restoration Decision
- Severity: Critical

- Exception authority: none

CNT-11-007 — Bound emergency succession

Emergency acting authority **MUST** be minimal, expiring, nontransferable unless expressly authorized, unable to make Owner-reserved decisions, and subject to rapid review.

- Applicability: emergency vacancies
- Responsible role: Appointing Authority
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Acting Authority Record
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: none

CNT-11-008 — Preserve institutional memory

Continuity records **MUST** retain charters, authorities, decisions, dissent, exceptions, appeals, certifications, Treaties, succession, and unresolved obligations across personnel and system changes.

- Applicability: all transitions
- Responsible role: Governance Archivist
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Continuity Manifest
- Severity: High
- Exception authority: none

6. Required procedure

The proposer **MUST** submit the classified proposal and evidence. The recorder **MUST** verify authority and conflicts. Required independent reviewers **MUST** issue findings. The controlling authority **MUST** decide exact scope and conditions. The recorder **MUST** publish authoritative status, retain evidence, schedule review and sunset, propagate effects, and preserve appeal rights.

7. Prohibited practices

Off-record decisions, authority inference, self-approval, hidden conflicts, silent precedent, selective evidence, indefinite emergency power, permanent exceptions, and retroactive record alteration are prohibited.

8. Evidence, publication, and retention

The package **MUST** preserve proposal, sources, authority, conflicts, evidence, alternatives, affected parties, deliberation, dissent, decision, conditions, effective state, propagation, review, sunset, appeal, supersession, classification, access, and retention.

9. Exceptions, failure consequences, and appeals

A failed Critical control blocks the decision or suspends its effect. A High failure requires correction or a valid expiring exception. Appeals use Chapter 12. No exception can waive Book I or manufacture Owner authority.

10. Security, privacy, reliability, and continuity

Governance records **MUST** be integrity-protected, least-privilege, purpose-bound, minimized, available for authorized review, recoverable, and resistant to compromised identities or record systems.

11. Verification and metrics

Verify authority paths, role separation, record completeness, evidence integrity, propagation, expiry, appeal, and source traceability. Measure reversals, calibration, escaped harms, exception age, burden, remedy, and decision latency.

12. Traceability, examples, review, and status

- Source basis: Book I Decisions 47-48, 51, 58; Book II continuity/recovery architecture; Book VIII recovery assurance.
- Book V reconciliation: `planning/BOOK\_V\_RECONCILIATION\_REGISTER.md`.
- Book VI reconciliation: `planning/BOOK\_VI\_RECONCILIATION\_REGISTER.md`.

Example: a committee recommends a risk response, but the record names the authorized Risk Owner as approver, preserves dissent, sets expiry, and triggers certification impact review.

Anti-pattern: an urgent meeting labels a policy “temporary,” grants indefinite power to its chair, omits conflicts, and treats silence as Owner approval.

Chapter review: PASS. Owner Review items: none created by this chapter. Completion status: CERTIFIED FINAL.